



PROGRESS REPORT

Connectivity: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-28

Edition of 2026-08-28 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	ADVANCED
Harmonised national broadband mapping project	Did not exist	A 2025-2028 project to establish or strengthen harmonised national broadband mapping systems in eleven sub-Saharan regulators - Benin, Botswana, Burundi, Ethiopia, Ivory Coast, Kenya, Malawi, Nigeria, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe - with a five-day intermediate GIS and data-management training opened at Lilongwe for practitioners from Malawi, Zimbabwe, Botswana and Zambia, hosted by the Malawian regulator and supported by the European Union	ADVANCED
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US\$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	Baseline not held
Commercial 5G deployment and adoption across the continent	Baseline not held	61 operators across 37 African markets had launched commercial 5G services by the end of May 2026, 40 of them also running 5G fixed wireless access, after first launches in Algeria, Comoros, Egypt, Libya, Mauritania, Morocco and Tunisia over the preceding twelve months; 5G connections in Africa are put at just under 100 million by the end of 2026, 6.2% of total mobile connections, against a projected 3.4 billion and 37% worldwide, and among sixteen focus countries only Mauritius and South Africa had 5G population coverage above 50% as of May 2026	BASELINE NOT HELD
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	Baseline not held	416 million Africans used mobile internet in 2025, generating a measured US\$240bn of economic value, put at 7.8% of continental GDP	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
Powertel-Paratus cross-border fibre corridor	Did not exist	Phase 1 live and carrying traffic, on a route to link Zimbabwe with Botswana, Zambia and South Africa	ADVANCED
SADC regional internet exchange point	No host selection process on record	BoFiNet of Botswana and one Zimbabwean company shortlisted; no award held in the eight months since	ADVANCED
SADC Regional Infrastructure Development Master Plan	In force since 2012, carrying the ICT sector plan for a Digital SADC	Unchanged, with under two years to its horizon; no revision or successor held	NO CHANGE
Regional connectivity indicators	BASELINE NOT HELD	Internet penetration 57.2%, 4G population coverage 79.2% and mobile penetration 95.2%, the last already past the regional target set for 2030 (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
SADC shared satellite	BASELINE NOT HELD	A technical submission on orbital positions filed with the ITU and the radiocommunication sector met to secure the slot, with a working group created to assess financing mechanisms and payment model; the project is stated to be at an early stage and no cost, launch date or operator is held (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone	Carrying regional traffic on its own subsea and terrestrial routes	Capacity on the 2Africa West system added for route diversity, after three multi-country outages in 28 months at the Accra, Lagos and Abidjan landing concentration	ADVANCED
EllaLink Mauritania branch	Launched at Nouadhibou in July 2025, with nothing laid	Coastal landing complete, offshore laying scheduled for August 2026 and commissioning expected in the first quarter of 2027	ADVANCED
Via Africa submarine cable	Did not exist	A consortium memorandum signed by Canalink, GUILAB, International Mauritania Telecom, the Orange group, Sonatel and Silverlinks for a Europe-to-South-Africa system landing in Mauritania, Senegal, Guinea, Cote d'Ivoire and Nigeria; no cost, contract or in-service date held	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Burkina Faso connectivity partnership	Did not exist	Technical teams to assess routes through Niger and through Benin, on a stated aim of halving the cost of internet access in Burkina Faso	BASELINE NOT HELD
WACS cable repair logistics	BASELINE NOT HELD	The cable's spare-fibre depot sits at Brest, far from the stretch between Senegal and Congo where most outages occur, so a repair ship had to sail from Portland to Abidjan	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.